

The T-Shaped Programmer

What employers are actually describing when they say they want a well-rounded developer.

BREADTH — enough of everything to work with anyone on the team

front-end · back-end · databases · testing · security · deployment · version control

You do not need to be an expert in everything. You need to know enough to ask the right question and to understand the answer.

DEPTH
one area you
know deeply

Your depth is what makes you valuable. It is also the part that changes most over a career — you will grow more than one stem.

You are here to build the horizontal bar. The vertical one comes later, once you know what you enjoy.

Nobody starts T-shaped. Everyone starts as a dot, somewhere along the top.